

and is reasonably clear. The player switches off automatically, if left idle for about 5 seconds, and there's no way to customise this.

Menu navigation is also fairly simple, but the button placement was disappointing. Not only is it difficult to control the player when it is in your pocket, you need to dig deep into the menu to activate the hold mode. The clip-on carry pouch can be hooked on to your belt, but you still need to remove the device from the pouch to access the controls.

As far as audio quality goes, the bundled earphones provided above average quality output, but with noticeable vibration while playing heavy bass and treble tracks. It took us 1 minute and 36 seconds to transfer the 50 MB of music to the player over the USB 1.1 connection.



The yepp YP-90S offers a decent set of features in an extremely small package, but its dependency on its bundled software and absence of playlist and folder support may warrant a second thought. Also, the price tag of close to Rs 10,000 is too high.

- + Decent set of features
 - + Fast data transfer
 - Bundled application required to access memory
 - No playlist & folder support
 - Average quality earphones
- Price:** Rs 9,990

Samsung yepp YP-90S B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶

And the winner is...

Even though there were only five contenders for the top slot in this comparison, we saw a fair bit of variation in features, user-friendliness and performance. The Philips Nike psa[64 was the only player that came with a remote control, but was also the only one that can't be used as portable storage. The Creative LX100 was the only one with an internal rechargeable battery. The Creative LX100 and the Samsung yepp YP-90S both feature FM radio and customisable bass and treble settings. The Creative LX100 is the most feature-rich player amongst the lot, and is also the winner of our Best Performance award.

Both the Creative players were extremely easy to connect to a PC, since they do not require any drivers or software. All the players were small and lightweight, but Samsung was the only vendor to supply a carry pouch, while Philips Nike came with an arm band. The latter was the best in terms of intuitive button placement. The Apacer Audio Steno BP300 is good for comfort because it comes with lightweight clip-on headphones, in contrast to earphones supplied by other vendors.

In pure audio performance, it was a close contest between both the Creative models and the Philips Nike psa[64. However, the former impressed us enough with its great sound reproduction to take the top slot.

For our value for money award, it was a photo-finish between the two Creative siblings, but the Creative MuVo 64MB won because of its audio quality, extreme ease of use and a price tag of just about Rs 6,000. 

DEEPAK DHINGRA
deepak_dhingra@thinkdigit.com

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